

ELTAI 2025

TEACHER AND LEARNER NARRATIVES SHAPE THE FUTURE OF ENGLISH EDUCATION

The 19th International and 55th Annual Conference of the English Language Teachers' Association of India (ELTAI) was held from 12–15 November 2025 at CHRIST (Deemed to be University), Bengaluru. Centred on the theme "Lessons Taught, Lessons Learnt: Teacher and Learner Narratives," the conference emerged as a significant national and international forum for rethinking English language and literature education across school and higher education sectors.

A key highlight of ELTAI 2025 was the introduction of a dedicated School Education Track, running parallel to the Higher Education Track. This structural innovation enabled focused, context-sensitive discussions while fostering meaningful dialogue across educational levels. Over four days, nearly 550 research papers were presented by educators, scholars, and practitioners from India and abroad. The programme also featured plenary lectures, workshops, symposiums, panel discussions, lightning talks, and cultural events, making it one of the most expansive ELTAI conferences to date.

The conference commenced with a formal inaugural ceremony attended by a distinguished panel including Prof. T. Kumari Kharbamon, President, ELTAI; Dr Fr. Joseph C. C., Vice Chancellor, CHRIST (Deemed to be University); Dr P. N. Ramani, Patron, ELTAI; Dr Xavier Pradheep Singh, Secretary, ELTAI; Dr Bhavani S, Dean, School of Humanities and Performing Arts, CHRIST University; Dr K. Elango, Chief Executive Chair, ELTAI; and Dr Vaibhav Sabnis and Dr Kishore Selva Babu, Convenors of ELTAI 2025. The inauguration was graced by Mr Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, Hon'ble Minister for School Education, Tamil Nadu, as Guest of Honour. In his address, the Minister emphasised the need for inclusive English education rooted in India's multilingual reality. While the mother tongue, he noted, anchors identity, English represents opportunity. He urged educators to position English as a tool for empowerment rather than privilege. The occasion also saw the release of key ELTAI publications, including the Journal of English Language Teaching and the 2025 conference proceedings.



Across sessions, participants engaged with pressing issues shaping contemporary English education, including artificial intelligence in pedagogy, multilingual and translanguaging practices, assessment reform, teacher wellbeing, and learner agency. While several discussions explored the creative and adaptive potential of AI, there was a consistent reaffirmation of the teacher's irreplaceable role, highlighting ethical use of technology, originality, and the centrality of human connection in learning.

The academic programme was enriched by cultural performances, creative writers' interactions, storytelling sessions, and heritage walks, underscoring literature, art, and place-based learning as vital pedagogical resources.

The conference concluded with a reflective valedictory ceremony led by Prof. Shravan Kumar, National Vice President of ELTAI, with the conference report presented by Dr S. Daniel Gnanraj. The closing proceedings included a keynote address by Dr John Varghese, Principal of St Stephen's College, and a valedictory address by Dr Ezhilan Naganathan, MLA, Thousand Lights, Tamil Nadu. Dr P. Jeyappriya, Registrar (i/c), Mother Teresa Women's University, and Dr Sharon S, Co-Convenor of ELTAI 2025, were also part of the valedictory session.

ELTAI 2025 reaffirmed the association's pivotal role in shaping an English education ecosystem that is inclusive, multilingual, technologically informed, and deeply human-centred.